Prototyping CLNx for Improved Usability

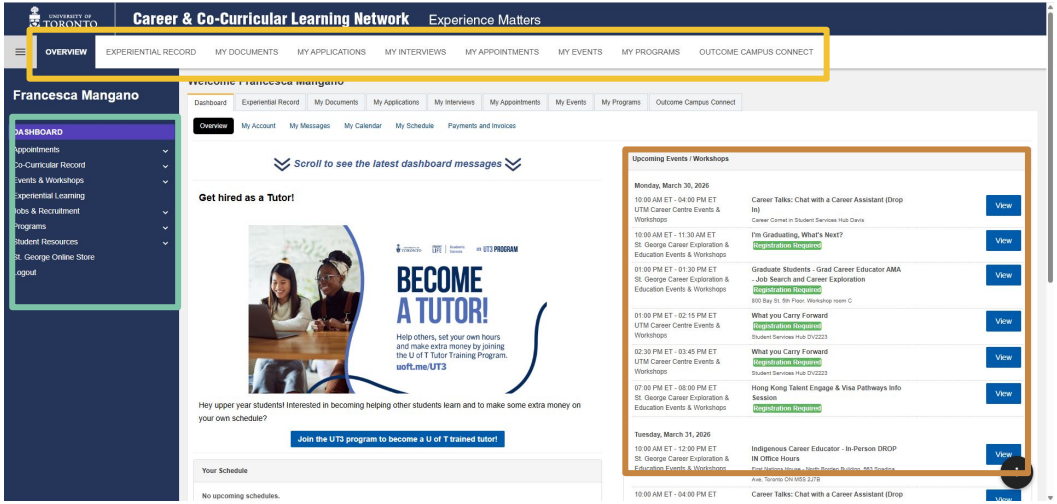
Presented by Francesca Mangano

CLNx: A career platform for students, by the UofT Career Centre

Main user group: Students looking for career advancement opportunities

Access to schedules, interviews, appointments, etc.

Resources and job boards



Upcoming internal workshops and events

Step 1: Identifying concerns with the current CLNx model

We collected data on how users perform the following tasks:

1. Finding and shortlisting an on-campus job of their choice
2. Booking an appointment

User group: UofT undergraduate engineering students (9 responses)

Moderated task walkthrough

Asynchronous survey

Task analysis identified 3 main concerns with job shortlisting

Concern	Evidence
Unclear entrypoint for finding on-campus jobs	Participants verbalized concerns with finding all job listings (survey)
Complicated filtering system	Many participants either a) Didn't use the filtering system and scrolled past it b) Only used the 'keyword search' feature when the filtering system had a way to filter another way
Noisy interactions	Participants expressed concerns discriminating information they were looking for

These concerns with the current website were further validated during Usability Testing

Step 2: Addressing these concerns in our prototype

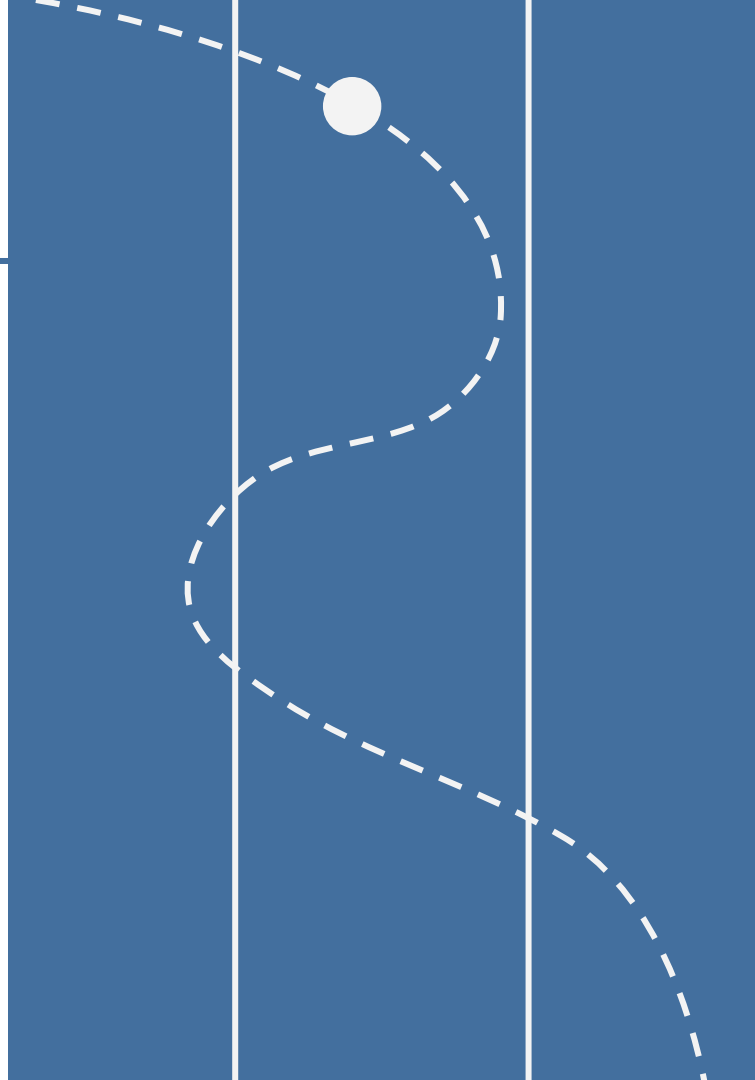
We addressed these concerns in 4 main ways:

01
Better selected starting page

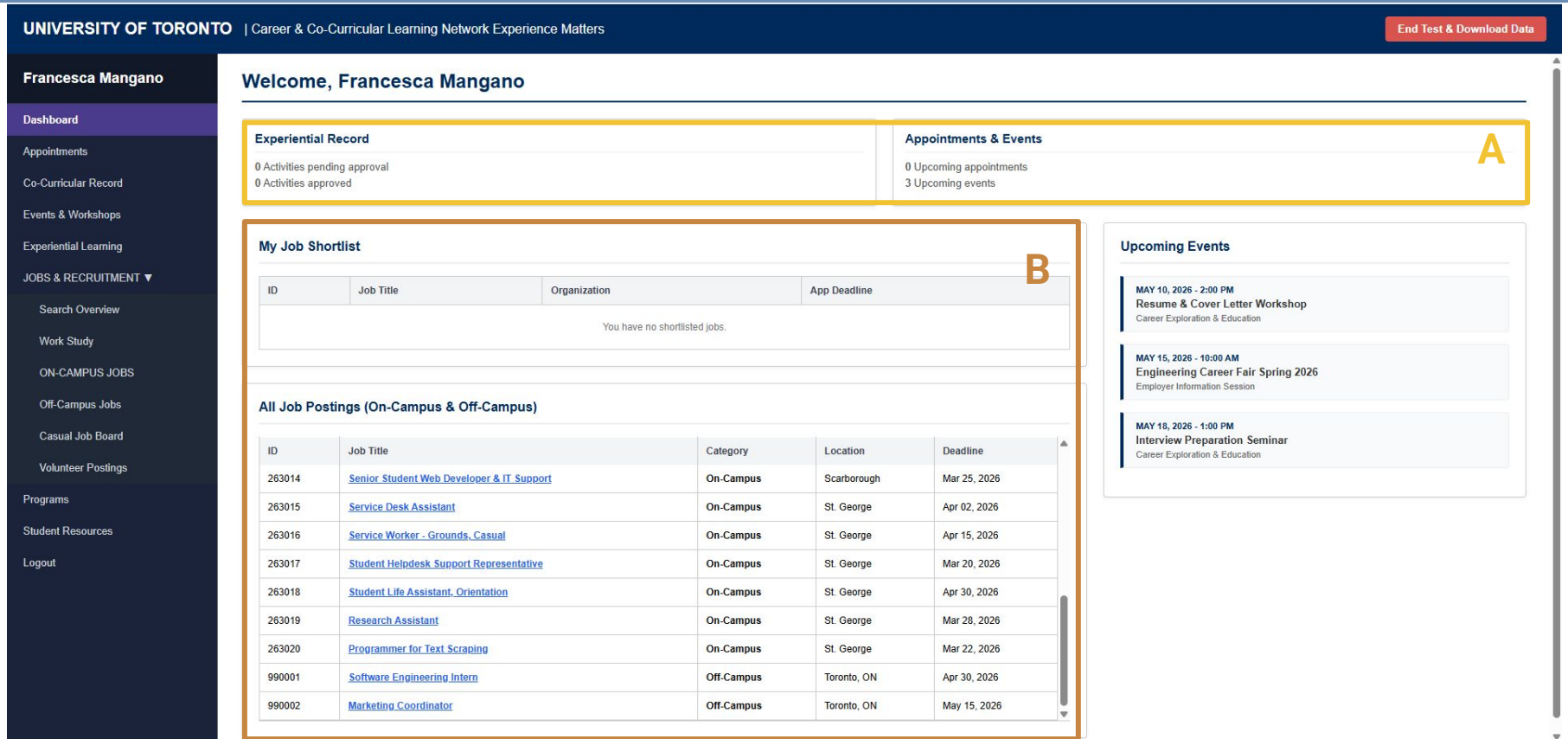
02
Enhanced filtering system

03
Discriminable shortlist status in job postings

04
Results preview

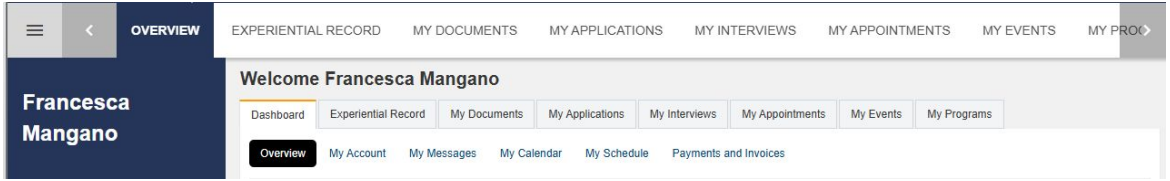


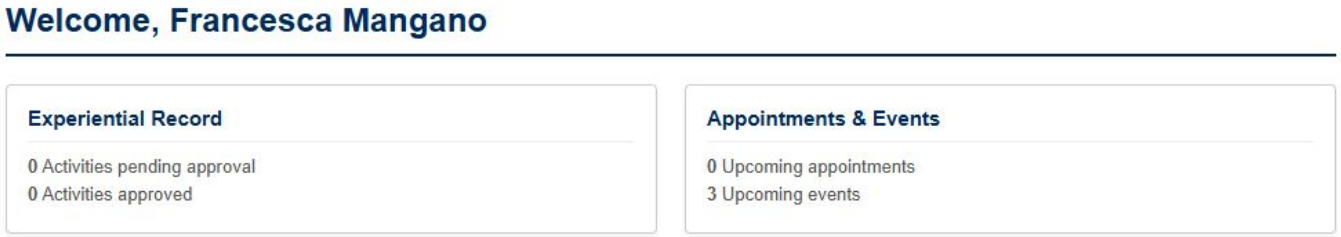
01: Our new starting page allows easier access to job postings



A: Minimal heading bar

Current solution redundantly showcases information while not directing the user to the job board in any way





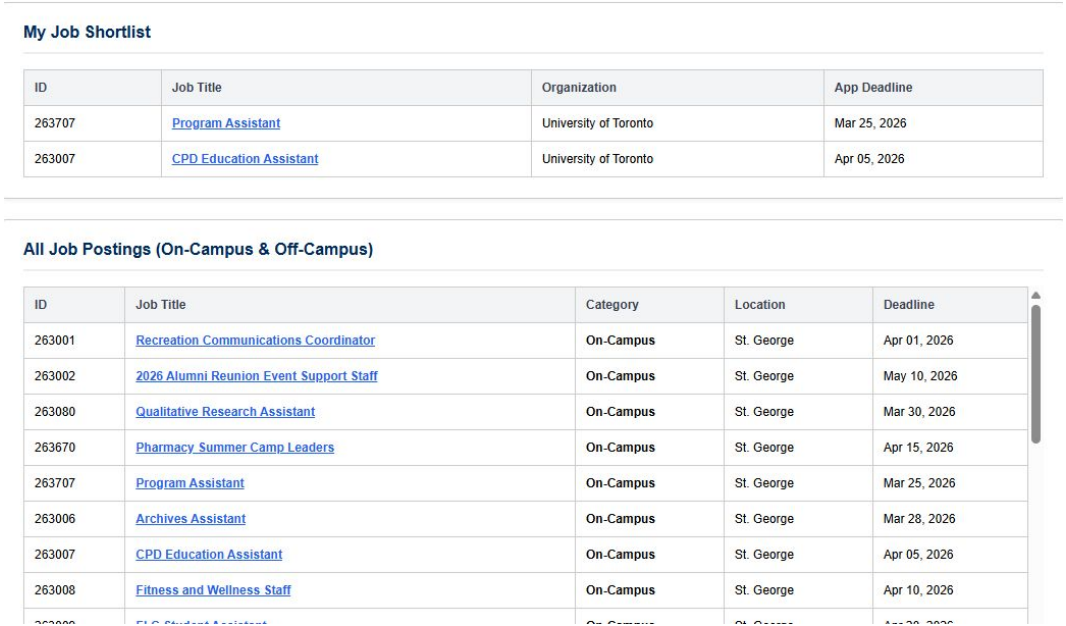
New prototype clearly shows what personalized information is relevant to each user

Design principles considered:

- Aesthetics and simplicity
- Existing information can be easily discriminated
  - 0 if query doesn't exist
  - # for how many of that query exist

Goal: Remove redundant information and point users to the job board

B: Accessible list shortlist and jobs



My Job Shortlist

ID	Job Title	Organization	App Deadline
263707	Program Assistant	University of Toronto	Mar 25, 2026
263007	CPD Education Assistant	University of Toronto	Apr 05, 2026

All Job Postings (On-Campus & Off-Campus)

ID	Job Title	Category	Location	Deadline
263001	Recreation Communications Coordinator	On-Campus	St. George	Apr 01, 2026
263002	2026 Alumni Reunion Event Support Staff	On-Campus	St. George	May 10, 2026
263080	Qualitative Research Assistant	On-Campus	St. George	Mar 30, 2026
263670	Pharmacy Summer Camp Leaders	On-Campus	St. George	Apr 15, 2026
263707	Program Assistant	On-Campus	St. George	Mar 25, 2026
263006	Archives Assistant	On-Campus	St. George	Mar 28, 2026
263007	CPD Education Assistant	On-Campus	St. George	Apr 05, 2026
263008	Fitness and Wellness Staff	On-Campus	St. George	Apr 10, 2026

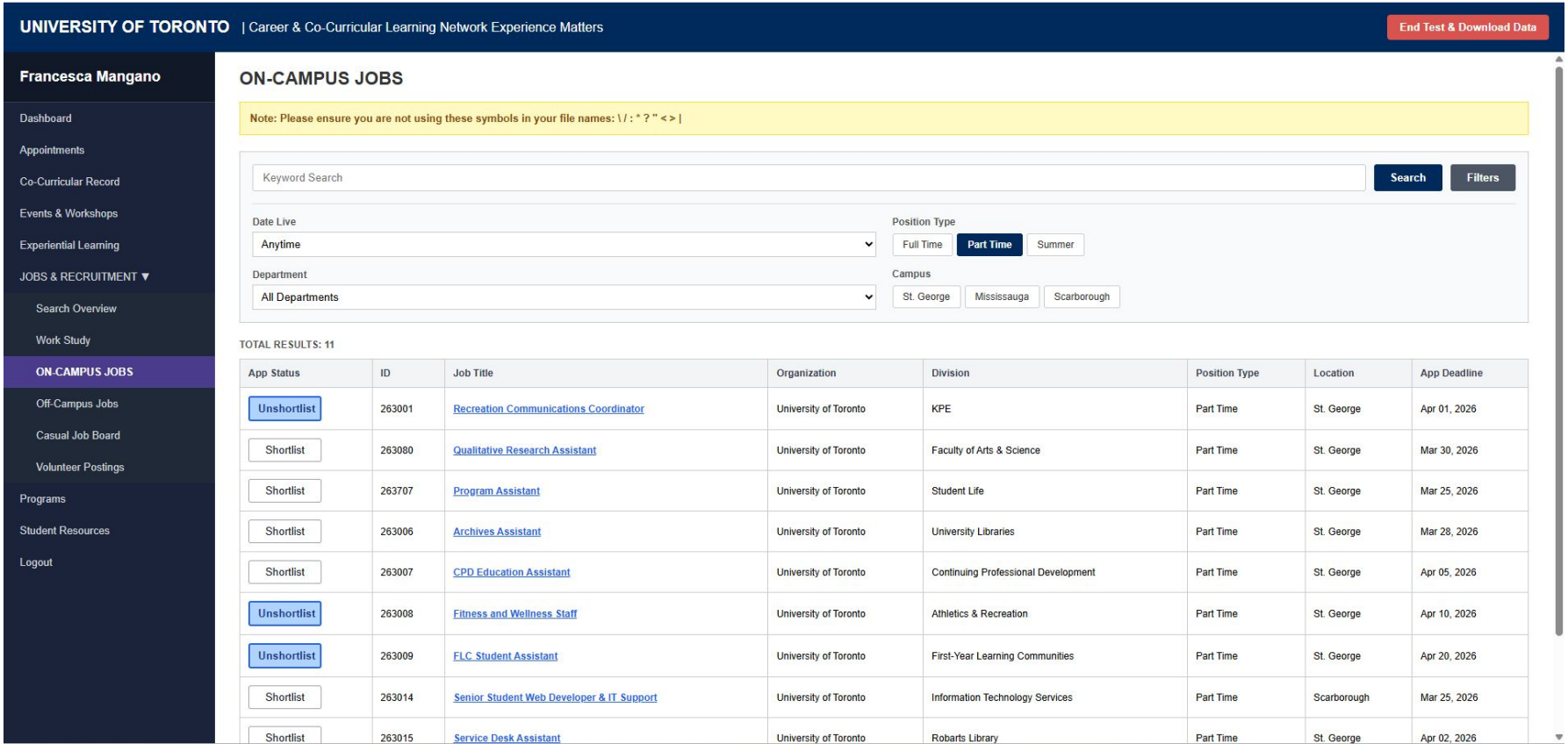
New shortlist is accessible in 4 fewer steps!

Design principles considered:

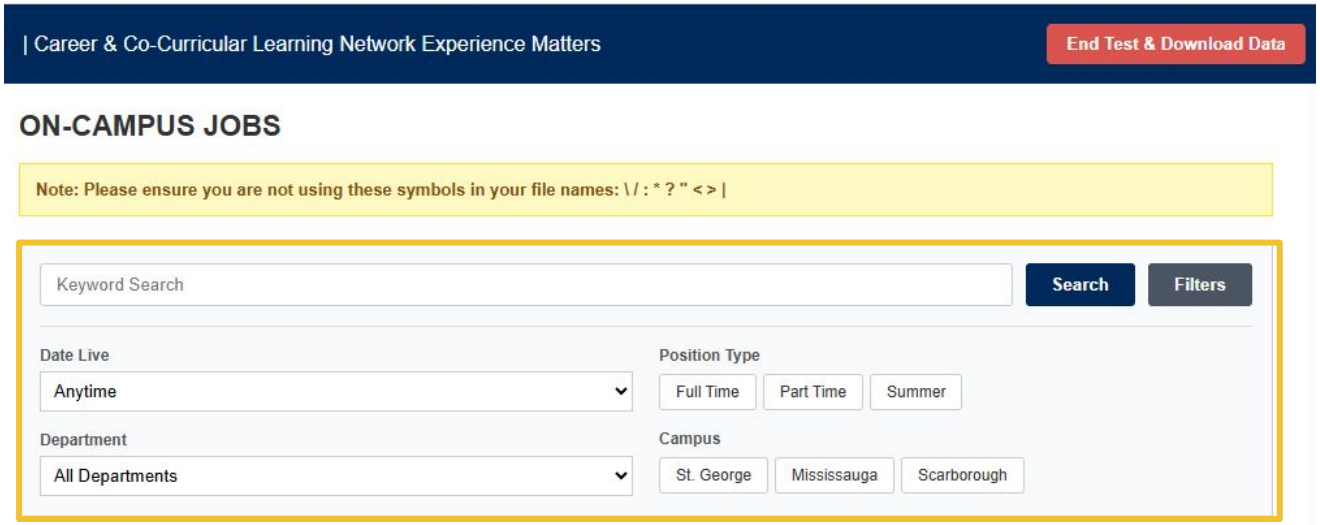
- Optimizing information accessibility
  - List of shortlisted jobs (with deadlines and job IDs) is presented to the user as soon as they enter the dashboard
- Simplicity and aesthetics
  - Shortlist only shows columns that have relevant information

Goal: Allow users to access their shortlist in fewer steps

Dashboard > Jobs & Recruitment > On Campus Jobs



02: Enhanced filtering only includes relevant information



4 main filtering categories:

- Determined by what participants filter for the most
- Filters with less than 3 options were converted to buttons

Design principles considered:

- Simplicity and aesthetics
- Decreasing density and noise of filtering webpage

Goal: Reduce complexity of filtering webpage

03: Discriminable shortlisting status in job board

App Status	ID	Job Title	Organization	Division	Position Type	Location	App Deadline
Unshortlist	263001	Recreation Communications Coordinator	University of Toronto	KPE	Part Time	St. George	Apr 01, 2026
Shortlist	263002	2026 Alumni Reunion Event Support Staff	University of Toronto	Alumni Relations	Casual	St. George	May 10, 2026
Shortlist	263080	Qualitative Research Assistant	University of Toronto	Faculty of Arts & Science	Part Time	St. George	Mar 30, 2026
Unshortlist	263670	Pharmacy Summer Camp Leaders	University of Toronto	Faculty of Pharmacy	Summer	St. George	Apr 15, 2026

Design principles considered:

- Increased discriminability of shortlisted rows
  - Color palette was optimized to increase salience amongst background
- Minimizing need to scan each row to find shortlisted jobs

Goal: Make shortlisted jobs easier to identify in job board

04: Results preview

App Status	ID	Job Title	Organization	Division	Position Type	Location	App Deadline
Unshortlist	263001	Recreation Communications Coordinator	University of Toronto	KPE	Part Time	St. George	Apr 01, 2026
Shortlist	263080	Qualita		of Arts & Science	Part Time	St. George	Mar 30, 2026
Shortlist	263707	Progra		t Life	Part Time	St. George	Mar 25, 2026
Shortlist	263006	Archiv		sity Libraries	Part Time	St. George	Mar 28, 2026
Shortlist	263007	CPD Ec		uing Professional pment	Part Time	St. George	Apr 05, 2026

JOB DETAILS

Start Date: May 1, 2026
End Date: August 31, 2026
Number of positions: 1
Salary: $18.00/hr
Job Description: Coordinate recreation communications, manage social media, and support event promotion.

Design principles considered:

- Increasing accessibility to relevant information
  - Applicants are typically looking for salary, start/end date, description, etc.
- Simplicity

Goal: Increase relevant information accessibility

Step 3: Usability testing on the old vs new CLNx website

Our goal was to create a test that evaluates our solutions to our identified problems

- User group: University of Toronto engineering undergraduate students (3-5 participants)
    - ***Different from previous group***

Users were tasked with performing the same 3 tasks on the current vs new CLNx prototype:

1. Shortlisting a job
2. Applying the “Summer” and “St. George” filters on a search
3. Finding the job description of a particular job

Qualitative data collection: In-person interviews

In person interviews helped us get meaningful user feedback for each task

Example questions:

- Have you used CLNx before? If so, how often?
- On a scale from 1-10, how difficult did you find the task?
- What was the most difficult step and why?
- How did you find completing this task different on the new prototype versus the actual version?

Hello. Thank you for taking the time to complete our group's usability testing for our CLNx prototype. This research study should take at maximum, 10 minutes. Please confirm that you have read and signed the consent form.

Before we begin, we have a few preliminary questions to gauge your familiarity with the site:

1. What is your year and major?
2. Have you used CLNx before? If so, how often?

Thank you. We will begin the first task.

Task 1: Shortlisting job on old CLNx interface

Share your screen (if study is done virtually). Complete the following task: Shortlist an on-campus UTSG job of your choosing, talk through the steps you complete

Debrief questions:

1. On a scale from 1-10 (with 10 being the most difficult), how difficult did you find the task?
2. What was the most difficult step and why?

Task 2: Applying the "Summer" and "St. George" filters to find a job on old CLNx website

Reset your screen to the "Dashboard" page. Complete the following task: Apply the filters called "Summer" and "St. George" to your search, talk through the steps you complete.

Debrief questions:

1. On a scale from 1-10 (with 10 being the most difficult), how difficult did you find the task?
2. What was the most difficult step and why?

Task 3: Finding the description of a job on old CLNx website

Quantitative data collection: Website feedback

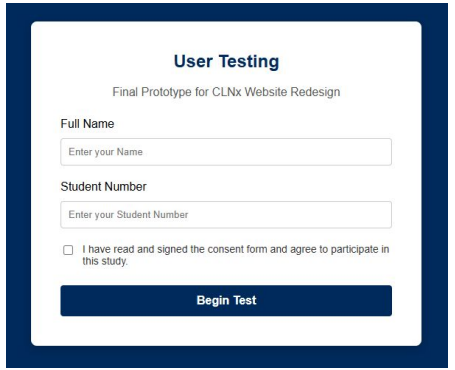
Our prototype keylogs to record the following user data:

- How much time is spent on each webpage
- What the user hovers over
- What toggles are selected
- Whether or not a user scrolls through a webpage

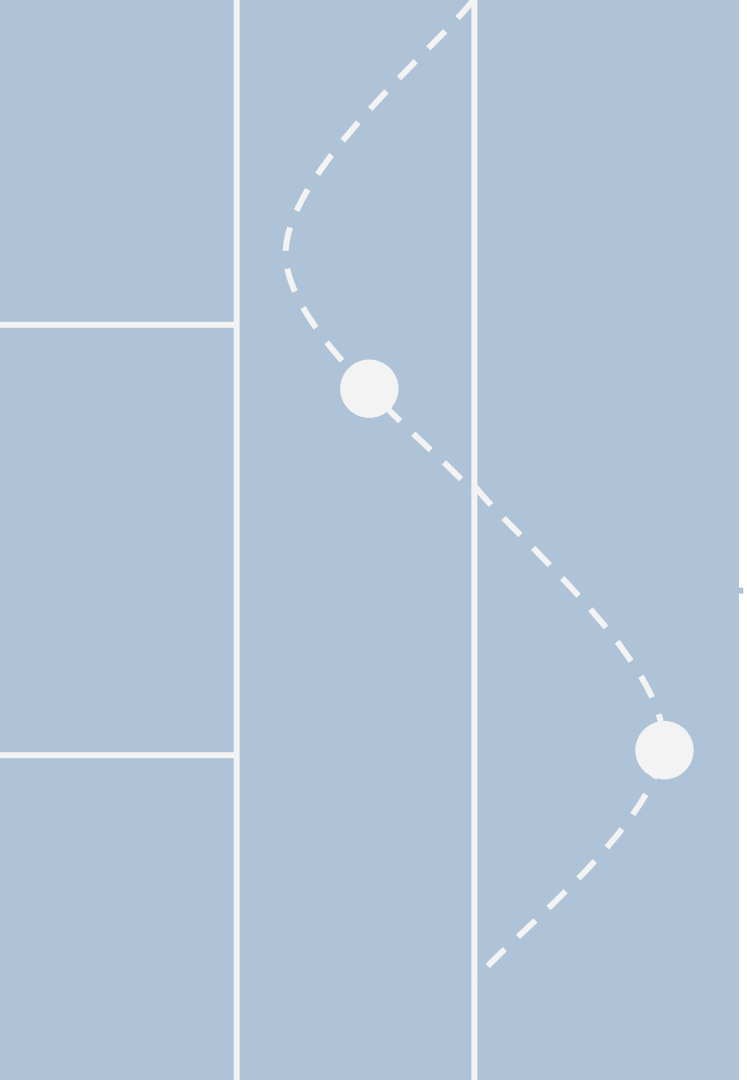
CLNX_Redesign_Prototype / test_results / CLNx_TestResults_0_1774465770942.csv

Preview | Code | Blame | 40 lines (39 loc) · 1.45 KB

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Sequence Number,Action Taken,Time Elapsed (Seconds)
1,"Sidebar: Dashboard",0.00
2,"Test Started",0.00
3,"Sidebar: Off-Campus Jobs",20.18
4,"Sidebar: ON-CAMPUS JOBS",22.68
5,"Hovered Preview Tooltip: 263001",24.94
6,"Hovered Preview Tooltip: 263001",24.99
7,"Added to Shortlist: Job 263001",26.85
8,"Sidebar: Dashboard",29.86
9,"Sidebar: ON-CAMPUS JOBS",110.21
10,"Opened Advanced Filters",113.13
11,"Toggled Position filter: Summer",117.53
12,"Toggled Campus filter: St. George",118.88
13,"Hovered Preview Tooltip: 263670",122.93
```



This is done with the consent of the participant and is used to analyze how much time is allocated to each part of the task



Next steps

Continue data collection

Collect data for remaining participants

Implement changes

Based on data collection, use HF design principles to finalize design

Any questions?

